

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	CHAINSAW - SAFE OPERATION	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Signature: _____			
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> Phone	<u>31/08/2025 – V11.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L Likely	M Moderate	U Unlikely
H (1) (High level of harm)	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) (High)	1	1	2
M (2) (Medium level of harm)	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) (Medium)	1	2	3
L (3) (Low level of harm)	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) (Low)	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Chainsaw safety	Unsafe operation. Potential injuries to personnel and bystanders	1	- Only trained and competent operators should use a chainsaw. - Chainsaws must conform to the applicable provisions of AS 2726. Part 1 and Part 2. - Use and operation of chainsaws must be in accordance with the applicable provisions of AS 2727. - PPE – a chainsaw operator must not only ensure that the machine is in safe operating condition but must also wear protective clothing for optimum protection. Close fitting clothing 'only' - to be worn when operating chainsaw. Head Protection (<i>hard hat</i>). A hard hat should be worn at all times as protection from failing material, and to reduce injuries from kickback. Ear Protection (ear muffs/ear plugs). All operators and assistants etc. should wear suitable ear protection. Chainsaws operate in the region of 100-110 dB(A) at the operator's ear, therefore careful consideration must be given to the attenuation of the ear protector. Eye Protection (goggles/glasses/mesh & perspex screens). The chain on the saw rotates at more than 40 km/h, so chips and material can be flung at the operator's eyes at very high speed. Leg Protection (long pants & chaps) leg protectors in a variety of kevlar and nylons are most effective in preventing cuts to the operators legs – a common problem. Foot Protection (safety boots). These should have steel toe caps, non-slip deep tread soles or have metal sprigs or cleats to protect toes from saw cuts and feet from failing material. Hand Protection (gloves). As well as protecting hands from cuts, abrasions etc. and keeping them warm, they prevent vibration induced problems such as Raynaud's Disease. - The chain saw - The chainsaw should be equipped with the following items: - A chain brake (preferably automatic) to prevent injury in the event of kickback. - Interlock throttle system, to prevent uncontrolled activation of the throttle. - Chain catcher and rear hand protector, to protect the saw and operator in the event of chain breakage.	Competent Chainsaw operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			- Anti-vibration system, to reduce exposure to vibration. - A low-kick chain (safety chain) to provide protection from kickback. - Symbols attached to identify to users that heavy duty hearing protection is required.		
Operator Safety	Unsafe operation. Potential injuries to personnel and bystanders	1	When carrying chainsaw, engine must be turned off, guide bar and saw chain carried to the rear with the muffler away from the body. CHAINSAW KICKBACK Other than the obvious risk of physical contact with a moving chain, the <i>single most dangerous aspect of the saw is 'kickback'</i>. This occurs when the bar nose contacts an object, resulting in an instantaneous kick reaction. Is a situation where the chainsaw chain may be abruptly stopped, in some cases causing the guide bar to kick up and back towards the user, or may push the guide back towards the operator an operator may lose control of the saw due to this process. Severe injuries and sometimes death can result. To prevent kickback: - Avoid using the bar nose. Always be alert to anything coming in contact with the bar nose. Do not let the nose of the guide bar contact the log, branch or any other obstruction which could be contacted while operating the saw. - Ensure that safety chain is used, and that it is correctly sharpened and tensioned. - Always operate with two hands on the saw handles, with the thumb of the left hand placed under the front handle. Keep a firm grip on the saw with both hands when the engine is running, the R/H in the rear handle and the L/H on the front handle, thumbs and fingers should encircle the handles to achieve a firm grip, which enables the operator to maintain control of the saw and neutralize the kickback process. - Avoid the use of the saw above the shoulders and always keep the saw in front of the body. - Engine speed must remain high during the cut. - Stand to the side of the cutting path of the saw.	Competent Chainsaw operator	2
Fire Safety	Fire	1	Chainsaws can easily start fires, for two reasons: - Poorly maintained and/or faulty exhaust systems. - Ignition of spilt fuels by internal sparks. To avoid fires: - Ensure muffler is in good condition and fitted with a spark arrester screen.	Competent Chainsaw operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			- Keep muffler clean of carbon buildup and deposit. - Ensure that saw is correctly tuned. - Do not use on extreme fire danger days. - Do not spill fuel over saw when refuelling. - Make sure an fire extinguisher or knapsack is available on site.		
Chainsaw Operation	Unsafe operation. Potential injuries to personnel and bystanders	1	- Before attempting to do anything with the chainsaw READ THE MANUAL. - Ensure that all safety features are fitted and operational <i>before</i> starting to saw; that all covers, safety guards, are in place and bolts and nuts are tightened according to makers specifications. - Do not operate a chainsaw that is damaged or improperly adjusted, a check must be taken to ensure the chain stops moving when the throttle control trigger is released. - To start, place saw on ground, with foot through rear hand guard to steady the saw. - Make sure chain is not contacting anything prior to starting the engine DO NOT DROP START THE CHAINSAW AS THIS PROCESS IS VERY DANGEROUS. - Keep handles dry, clean and free of oil or fuel mixture. - Operate chainsaw only in well ventilated areas. - The operator must apply the chain brake when leaving the chainsaw running. - When transporting a chainsaw, ensure the appropriate guide bar scabbard is secured. - When crosscutting or pruning, check if any branches are 'under tension' before cutting. Caution; small size brush and saplings can catch the saw chain, pulling the operator off balance or shipping the branch towards the operator. - Seek advice and or training in the use of the chainsaw if you are not sure. Many accidents are the result of ignorance. - Always wear the recommended personal protective clothing.	Competent Chainsaw operator	2
Limbing and Sectioning	Unsafe operation. Potential injuries to personnel	1	- Whenever it is possible to do so, the chainsaw operator must work on the side of the trunk opposite to that which the limb is being cut. - The chainsaw operator should stand on the uphill side of the work whenever possible. - Timber under tension must be considered hazardous. - When necessary the chainsaw operator must chock a log to prevent it's rolling.	Chainsaw operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Felling of trees with chainsaw	Unsafe operation. Potential injuries to personnel	1	Tree felling should be carried out by trained and experienced personnel only. Assistance and advice should be sought if the operator is unsure how to fell a certain tree. - Before beginning any felling operation, the worker must carefully consider: - Soundness of the tree. - Surrounding objects that could interfere with the safe undertaking of the operation. - Shape and weight distributions of the canopy. - Lean of the tree. - Wind force, direction, and consistency. - Proximity of tree to nearby services (e.g. overhead powerlines). - Nature of the terrain. - Location of other persons. - Presence of "hangers" in the canopy. - Chainsaw is sharp, correctly tuned adequately filled with fuel and bar oil. - The work area must be cleared to permit safe working conditions, and an escape route must be planned before any cutting is started. - Suitable wedges must be available for use to prevent a tree falling in a direction other than that intended and/or, where necessary, to break the holdingwood. - Each tree worker must be instructed as to exactly what he is to do. - Any persons not directly involved in an operation must be kept clear of the work area to a distance of a least 2 times the height of the tree. - Special precautions in cabling or roping a rotten, leaning or split tree must be considered if it is likely that it may fall in a direction other than the intended direction of fall. Special precautions must be taken not to over-tension such cables or ropes to the extent that excessive and potentially dangerous reactive pressures are built up within the tree. - The operator must move away from the tree, along the pre-pared escape route, as the tree begins to fall.	Chainsaw operator	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste products will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	
Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.						
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card						
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)		Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required		Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management	
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training		Fire Extinguisher training		Fatigue Management Training	
A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.						
Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)						
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022						
Codes of Practice						
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020		Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018		
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020		Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019		
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020		WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018		
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018		Safe Design of Structures - 2018		
Plant & Equipment for this activity						
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.						
List of plant for this Activity						
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):						

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.

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